

## Chapter 174-3

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Liang Shi had no idea about all the twists and turns between them.

On the contrary, she and Xu Qingzhu both agreed that Lu Jiayi and Fu You were a good match.

They both felt that Lu Jiayi was someone with deep thoughts and was profit-driven, so it was better to match her with an innocent, naive girl who didn't know the ways of the world.

It was fortunate that Lu Jiayi didn't know this.

Otherwise, she would have coughed up blood.

This spring was a vibrant spring.

Everything was growing toward the sun, beautiful beyond words.

Liang Shi had completely adapted to the pace of life here. After finishing filming "Lingering Light," she seamlessly joined another production for that period drama. Although she was the second female lead, the character's personality was very appealing to fans.

Then came the enthusiastic response after "Let's Go Right Now" aired.

Especially after netizens learned that Liang Shi and Liang Xinran were the true and fake heiresses, they examined that show under a microscope. But the two really didn't have much interaction—Liang Shi barely spoke to Liang Xinran on the show.

Because of Liang Xinzhou's intervention, the production team cut many of Liang Shi's scenes.

This helped avoid conflicts.

And Liang Xinran also stopped causing trouble for Liang Shi.

To be precise, the two stayed out of each other's way—well water not interfering with river water.<sup>1</sup>

Also this spring, Liang Wanwan chose to study abroad.

Gu Yixue lazed around for the entire spring, saying she was polishing a script, but her new script was still nowhere in sight.

Everything was calm and peaceful.

Liang Shi would occasionally have meals with Zhao Xuning, occasionally bring wine to chat with Chen Mian, and occasionally stroll around Gu Yixue's studio.

Most of the time, she was rushing between the production set and home.

It was also this spring that Liang Shi decided to buy a house.

There happened to be a large flat-floor apartment for sale on the floor above them, so she bought it.

She didn't move directly into the house that Liang Xinzhou had given her.

The day of the move was a clear and sunny day. Liang Shi even invited Zhao Xuning and the others over for dinner.

Many people gathered at home. Under Sally's urging to drink, Liang Shi got completely drunk.

Somehow, Zhao Xuning also joined in the fun. Even though she had to be on duty the next day, she still got drunk with them, then slept on the floor for the night. When she woke up the next day, she was sneezing continuously.

Liang Shi was fine though. The next day, she could still get up to make hangover soup for her, while also trying to persuade her to skip work and not go to the hospital looking so sick—who knew if she was going there to be a doctor or to be admitted as a patient.

But Zhao Xuning remained unmoved, letting her words go in one ear and out the other—or perhaps they didn't even go in at all.

Xu Qingzhu was the most well-behaved. Even though they had changed residences, it didn't affect her much.

As a pregnant woman, she couldn't drink alcohol. Moreover, she was tired from packing the day before moving, so while they were still drinking, Xu Qingzhu was already so sleepy she couldn't keep her eyes open and went straight back to the room to sleep.

She didn't even know what time Liang Shi came back to the room.

When Xu Qingzhu got up and saw Zhao Xuning sneezing repeatedly and looking listless, she walked over to feel her forehead. But Zhao Xuning, who had her eyes lowered and looked dazed, suddenly grabbed her wrist.

Xu Qingzhu gasped.

Zhao Xuning immediately let go. "Sorry."

"It's fine." Xu Qingzhu even teased: "Good thing I've gained weight now. Otherwise, with my previous build, that grip would have snapped my bones."

Zhao Xuning pressed her temples and said nothing more.

But Xu Qingzhu said to her: "Dr. Zhao, you have a fever."

"Do I?" Zhao Xuning raised her hand to feel her own forehead.

"You can't tell by checking yourself." Xu Qingzhu went to look for a thermometer in the house, but since they had just moved, some miscellaneous items hadn't been unpacked yet and she couldn't find it at all. Zhao Xuning also told her not to bother—she had to go to the hospital soon anyway.

Liang Shi also came out and felt her forehead. "It does feel a bit hot."

She continued trying to persuade her not to go to the hospital, but Zhao Xuning didn't listen.

In the morning, Zhao Xuning left together with Chen Mian. Seeing her poor condition, Chen Mian dropped her off at the hospital entrance before going back to catch up on sleep.

While eating breakfast at home, Liang Shi chatted with Xu Qingzhu about last night. Gu Yixue had received a call after midnight and left by taxi.

Chen Mian, Zhao Xuning, Liang Shi, and Lin Luoxi drank until very late.

Although Sally kept clamoring to drink, her alcohol tolerance was average.

Not even as good as Lin Luoxi's.

Later, Zhao Ying had video-called Zhao Xuning and they chatted casually for a bit.

Afterward, Zhao Ying sent Zhao Xuning some message—no one knew what it said, but Zhao Xuning's expression changed after seeing it.

She started drinking like she was drinking water. If Liang Shi hadn't stopped her, she probably would have downed three bottles of baijiu<sup>2</sup> in a row.

Drinking until her stomach bled.

Xu Qingzhu shrugged: "It's probably related to Shen Hui."

"I think so too," Liang Shi said. "But what exactly happened?"

"Shen Hui's engagement date has been set," Xu Qingzhu said. "In half a month."

Liang Shi: "?"

"So sudden?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu didn't think so: "It's alright, I suppose. They've been talking about getting engaged since last year. Until now, it's been delayed for almost half a year. Maybe she was waiting for something."

Liang Shi: "Waiting for Zhao Xuning?"

Xu Qingzhu shook her head: "That I don't know."

Actually, they both knew it was ninety percent likely.

It's just that Zhao Xuning only took one step forward each time, then retreated at the slightest setback, not daring to move forward again. Whether she was afraid of Shen Hui or something else, no one knew.

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1. "井水不犯河水" (well water doesn't interfere with river water) is a Chinese idiom meaning two parties stay out of each other's business and don't interfere with one another. ⇐
2. Baijiu (白酒) - A strong Chinese distilled spirit, typically clear in color and with an alcohol content usually between 40-60%. It's one of the most consumed spirits in the world and is commonly served at Chinese banquets and celebrations. ⇐